October 2026

FTSE Classification of Equity Markets – FTSE Equity Country Classification September 2026 Annual Announcement

Published: 06 October 2026

A formal annual review of country classification within the FTSE global equity indices is conducted every September using a comprehensive, transparent and consistent methodology. This annual review incorporates ongoing equity country classification research and classifies markets as Developed, Advanced Emerging, Secondary Emerging or Frontier within the FTSE global equity indices.

Please refer to the FTSE Equity Country Classification Process document for further details.

The results of the 2026 Annual FTSE Equity Country Classification Review can be found in the remainder of this announcement.

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1. FTSE Equity Country Classification Watch List

To provide investors with visibility of the potential movement of markets between classifications, FTSE Russell maintains a Watch List of markets that are under review and being monitored for reclassification.

The following market was a member of the Watch List following the March 2026 Equity Country Classification Interim Review:

- **Egypt**: possible reclassification from Secondary Emerging to Frontier.

2. Progress of Watch List Markets since March 2026

Egypt – Reclassification from Secondary Emerging to Frontier market status

Egypt was added to the Watch List from September 2025 for possible reclassification from Secondary Emerging to Frontier market status. This was due to Egypt experiencing a steady decrease in the number of eligible Egyptian index constituents within FTSE Russell global benchmarks. This resulted in the market failing to meet the minimum securities count requirement as of year-end 2024 and month-end June 2025, with only one Egyptian index constituent in the FTSE Emerging Index (Large and Mid Cap), with the minimum requirement being at least two eligible index constituents.

Consequently, Egypt was added to the Watch List for potential demotion from Secondary Emerging to Frontier market status. Although the market continued to fail to meet the minimum securities count requirement based on data as of year-end 2025, the government's economic reforms and initiatives introduced by the Egyptian Exchange resulted in increased liquidity in the Egyptian equity market. This resulted in an additional Egyptian security meeting the index eligibility for the FTSE Emerging Index for the March 2026 index review and also the September 2026 index review. This resulted in three Egyptian Mid Cap designated index constituents and three Small Cap designated index constituents meeting the minimum size and securities count requirement.

Therefore, as Egypt meets the nine FTSE Quality of Markets criteria required for retaining Secondary Emerging market status within the FTSE Equity Country Classification scheme and the minimum size and securities count requirement, and following the feedback received from the FTSE Equity Country Classification Advisory Committee and the FTSE Russell Policy Advisory Board, the FTSE Russell Index Governance Board confirms, and is pleased to announce, that Egypt will be removed from the Watch List and retained as a Secondary Emerging market within FTSE Russell equity indices.

For further details on the minimum investable market capitalisation and securities count thresholds please refer to the FTSE Equity Country Classification process guide.

3. Previously confirmed reclassification

Greece – reclassification from Advanced Emerging to Developed market status

As part of the FTSE Equity Country Classification September 2025 annual review, FTSE Russell announced the reclassification of Greece from Advanced Emerging to Developed market status, effective from the open on Monday 21 September 2026.

Further details on the implementation of Greece to Developed market status is available in an FAQ published on the FTSE Russell website: Reclassification of Greece FAQ

Vietnam – reclassification from Frontier to Secondary Emerging market status

As part of the FTSE Equity Country Classification March 2026 interim review, FTSE Russell confirmed the reclassification of Vietnam from Frontier to Secondary Emerging market status, commencing with an initial 10% implementation from the open on Monday 21 September 2026, followed by three further tranches in March 2027, June 2027 and September 2027.

Further details on the implementation of Vietnam to Secondary Emerging market status is available in an FAQ published on the FTSE Russell website: Reclassification of Vietnam FAQ

Nigeria – reclassification from Unclassified to Frontier market status

On 27 August 2026, FTSE Russell confirmed the reclassification of Nigeria from Unclassified to Frontier market status, effective from the open on Monday 21 September 2026.

4. Other Markets

Indonesia (Secondary Emerging market status)

FTSE Russell continues to closely monitor capital market integrity reforms in Indonesia. Following the postponement of certain index changes for Indonesia at the March, June and September 2026 index reviews, FTSE Russell is assessing the effectiveness of recently implemented reform measures in supporting an orderly and stable transition back to standard index review processes, as outlined in the FTSE Russell FAQ on the Treatment of Indonesian Securities.

Indonesia has implemented a broad range of market reforms, including enhanced shareholder disclosure, expanded investor classification categories, minimum free float requirements, and enhanced market surveillance tools. These measures are intended to address previously identified concerns relating to data transparency and replicability. FTSE Russell will continue to monitor implementation and effectiveness of these measures and engage with market participants to gather feedback.

FTSE Russell will provide an update on the treatment of Indonesian securities ahead of the December 2026 index review, taking into consideration the progress of market reforms and feedback received from stakeholders.

Indonesia's Secondary Emerging market status remains unchanged. FTSE Russell is not placing Indonesia on the Watch List and will continue monitoring market developments and engaging with market participants as part of its ongoing assessment.

South Korea (Developed market status)

Settlement – Funding Requirement

FTSE Russell continues to monitor settlement funding requirements in the South Korean market. The South Korean market authorities are implementing a range of reforms aimed at enhancing settlement liquidity and reducing funding pressures associated with Settlement Progress Payments (SPPs), including the use of securities as collateral, the alignment of exchange and institutional settlement processes, and measures to facilitate KRW funding. While these initiatives are intended to improve settlement efficiency and reduce liquidity requirements for international investors, implementation remains ongoing and market participants have indicated that further operational experience is required to assess their effectiveness. FTSE Russell will continue to monitor developments and engage with market participants on this issue.

Investment Alert / Investment Risk Lists

FTSE Russell continues to monitor the operation of the Korea Exchange (KRX) Market Warning System, including Investment Alert and Investment Risk designations. In response to feedback from market participants regarding the potential impact of these measures on index replication, FTSE Russell has updated the FTSE Global Equity Index Series Ground Rules to provide greater clarity regarding the eligibility and treatment of securities subject to market warning measures. FTSE Russell will continue to engage with market participants and monitor developments in this area.

FTSE Russell will continue to monitor developments in South Korea's short selling, settlement, and market-warning framework, and welcomes feedback from market participants, as well as continued engagement with the South Korean market authorities to address the issues outlined above.

Taiwan (Advanced Emerging market status)

FTSE Russell notes that the Central Bank of the Republic of China (Taiwan) (CBC) maintains a daily net New Taiwan Dollars (TWD) purchase limit of US$100 million for Foreign Institutional Investors (FINIs) to support the orderly functioning and stability of the foreign exchange market. This limit can impact the ability of index trackers to replicate benchmark treatment, such as significant corporate events and index reviews. FTSE Russell continues to engage with the Taiwanese market authorities on this issue.

Türkiye (Advanced Emerging market status)

Following the postponement of certain index changes for Türkiye at the September 2026 index review, FTSE Russell continues to engage with Borsa İstanbul and the Capital Markets Board of Türkiye (CMB) which is reviewing the feasibility to improve the granularity underpinning the Central Securities Depositary's (MKK) published free float figures.

FTSE Russell is not placing Türkiye on the Watch List and its Advanced Emerging market status remains unchanged.

5. New Addition to the Watch List

Oman (Frontier market status)

Oman is added to the Watch List for possible reclassification from Frontier to Secondary Emerging market status. Oman meets the nine FTSE Quality of Markets criteria required for attaining Secondary Emerging market status within the FTSE Equity Country Classification scheme, and meets the minimum investable market capitalisation and securities count requirement for a Secondary Emerging market, based on data as of month-end June 2026.

The minimum securities count requirement requires at least three securities meeting the index eligibility requirements for Large or Mid Cap and a total of at least five securities meeting the index eligibility requirements for Large, Mid and Small Cap. For further details on the minimum investable market capitalisation and securities count thresholds please refer to the FTSE Equity Country Classification Process guide.

FTSE Russell will conduct another minimum size and securities count requirement assessment on Oman based on data as of year-end December 2026 and provide an update on the Watch List status of Oman as part of the FTSE Equity Country Classification March 2027 Interim Review. Watch List indices reflecting the reclassification of Oman as a Secondary Emerging market will be published by the beginning of 2027.

6. Date of Next Announcement

The March 2027 Interim Review Announcement will be published on Tuesday 06 April 2027.

For more information please visit: Equity Country Classification | LSEG

The table below shows the markets classified within the FTSE Equity Country Classification scheme as at 06 October 2026:

Developed	Advanced Emerging	Secondary Emerging	Frontier
Australia	Brazil	Chile	Bahrain
Austria	Czech Republic	China	Bangladesh
Belgium/Luxembourg	Hungary	Colombia	Botswana
Canada	Malaysia	Egypt	Bulgaria
Denmark	Mexico	Iceland	Côte d'Ivoire
Finland	South Africa	India	Croatia
France	Taiwan	Indonesia	Cyprus
Germany	Thailand	Kuwait	Estonia
Greece*	Türkiye	Philippines	Ghana
Hong Kong		Qatar	Jordan
Ireland		Romania	Kazakhstan
Israel		Saudi Arabia	Kenya
Italy		United Arab Emirates	Latvia
Japan		Vietnam**	Lithuania
Netherlands			Malta
New Zealand			Mauritius
Norway			Mongolia
Poland			Morocco
Portugal			Nigeria***
Singapore			Oman
South Korea			Pakistan
Spain			Palestine
Sweden			Peru
Switzerland			Republic of North Macedonia
UK			Serbia
USA			Slovak Republic
			Slovenia
			Sri Lanka
			Tanzania
			Tunisia

*Greece reclassified from Advanced Emerging to Developed market status, effective from Monday 21 September 2026.

**Vietnam reclassified from Frontier to Secondary Emerging market status, effective from Monday 21 September 2026.

***Nigeria reclassified from Unclassified to Frontier market status, effective from Monday 21 September 2026.

Matrix of Markets

(Source: FTSE Russell as of 06 October 2026. Past performance is no guarantee of future results. Please see disclaimer for important legal information).

	SEGMENTS								AMERICAS								ASIA PACIFIC																EUROPE														MEA		
	All-World	World	Developed	Advanced Emerging	Emerging	Secondary Emerging	EMEA	All-World BRIC	All-World ex USA	All-World ex NA	Developed ex USA	Developed ex NA	All-World Americas	All-World North America	All-World Latin America	Emerging Latin America	All-World ex Japan	World ex Japan	All-World ex Asia	Developed ex Japan (FTSE Kaigai)	Developed Asia Pacific	Developed Asia Pacific ex Japan	Developed Europe Asia Pacific	All-World Europe-Asia Pacific	All-World Asia Pacific	All-World Asia Pacific ex Japan	All-World Asia Pacific ex Japan, India & Pakistan	All-World Asia Pacific ex Japan, Australia & New Zealand	All-World Asia ex Japan, Hong Kong, Australia & New Zealand	All-World Asia Pacific ex Japan, Australia, New Zealand, India	All-World Asean	All-World Greater China	Emerging Asia Pacific	All-World ex UK	All-World ex Eurozone	Developed ex Eurozone	Developed ex UK	Developed Europe	Developed Europe ex UK	Developed Europe ex Eurozone ex UK	All-World Europe	All-World Eurozone	All-World Europe ex UK	All-World Europe ex Eurozone	All-World Europe ex Eurozone ex UK	All-World Eastern Europe	All-World Nordic	Emerging Europe	All-World ex South Africa	All-World Middle East and Africa	
Australia	·	·	·						·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·								·		Australia
Austria	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Austria
Belgium/Luxembourg	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Belgium/Luxembourg
Brazil	·	·		·	·			·	·	·			·		·	·	·	·	·													·	·										·		Brazil
Canada	·	·	·						·		·		·	·			·	·	·	·													·	·	·	·								·		Canada
Chile	·				·	·			·	·			·		·	·	·		·														·	·										·		Chile
China	·				·	·		·	·	·							·							·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·										·		China
Colombia	·				·	·			·	·			·		·	·	·		·														·	·										·		Colombia
Czech Republic	·	·		·	·			·	·	·							·	·	·					·									·						·	·	·	·	·	·		Czech Republic
Denmark	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·		·		·		Denmark
Egypt	·				·	·	·	·	·	·							·		·														·	·										·	·	Egypt
Finland	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Finland
France	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		France
Germany	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Germany
Greece	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Greece
Hong Kong	·	·	·						·	·	·	·					·	·		·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·		·		·		·	·	·						·		Hong Kong
Hungary	·	·		·	·			·	·	·							·	·	·					·									·						·	·	·	·	·	·		Hungary
Iceland	·				·	·	·	·	·	·							·		·					·									·						·		·	·	·	·		Iceland
India	·				·	·		·	·	·							·							·	·	·	·		·	·		·	·										·		India
Indonesia	·				·	·			·	·							·							·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·										·		Indonesia
Ireland	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Ireland
Israel	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·													·	·	·	·						·	·	Israel
Italy	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Italy
Japan	·	·	·						·	·	·	·									·		·	·	·								·	·	·	·								·		Japan
Kuwait	·				·	·	·		·	·							·		·														·	·										·	·	Kuwait
Korea	·	·	·						·	·	·	·					·	·		·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·		·	·	·	·								·		Korea
Malaysia	·	·		·	·				·	·							·	·						·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·										·		Malaysia
Mexico	·	·		·	·				·	·			·		·	·	·	·	·														·	·										·		Mexico
Netherlands	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Netherlands
New Zealand	·	·	·						·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·						·	·	·	·								·		New Zealand
Norway	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·		·		·		Norway
Philippines	·				·	·			·	·							·							·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·										·		Philippines
Poland	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·		·		·		Poland
Portugal	·	·	·					·	·	·	·	·					·	·	·	·			·	·								·			·	·	·						·		Portugal
Qatar	·				·	·	·	·	·	·							·		·														·	·										·	·	Qatar
Romania	·				·	·	·	·	·	·							·		·					·									·	·						·	·	·	·	·	·		Romania
Saudi Arabia	·				·	·	·		·	·							·		·														·	·										·	·	Saudi Arabia
Singapore	·	·	·						·	·	·	·					·	·		·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	·		·	·	·	·								·		Singapore
South Africa	·	·		·	·			·	·	·							·	·	·														·	·										·		South Africa

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